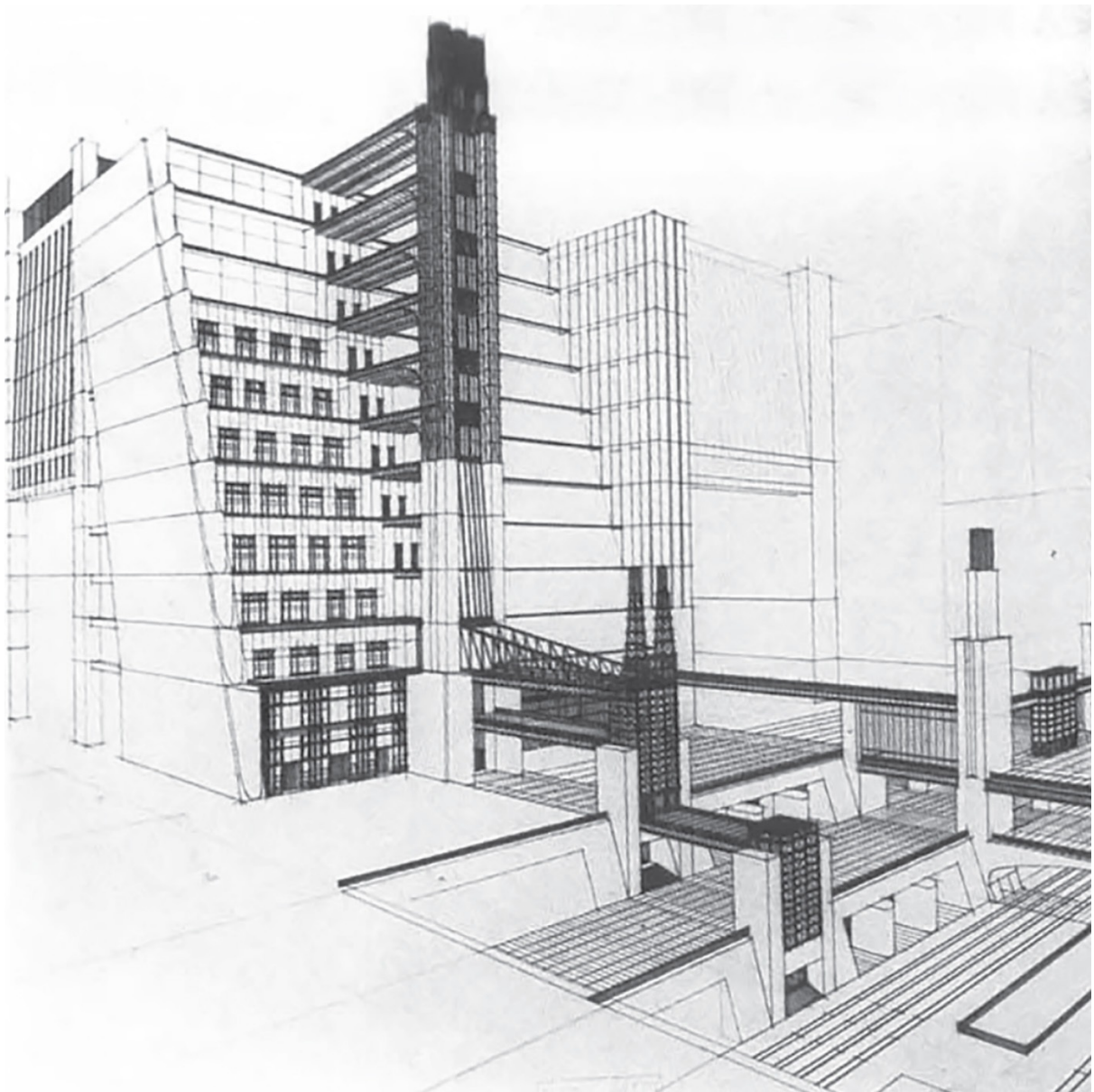


Futurism

The rationale of futurist architecture, an Italian movement of the early 20th century, is best represented in hundreds of drawings by the architects Antonio Sant'Elia (1888–1916) and Mario Chiattone (1891–1957). Futurism's founder, the poet Filippo Tommaso Marinetti (1876–1944), produced its first manifesto in 1909. Inspired by the machine age and the glorification of war, futurists rejected the past in favour of radical new ideas, embodied in vast cities with soaring towers and megastructures. In 1914, Sant'Elia wrote the official *Manifesto of Futurist Architecture*, explaining how architecture should be meaningful and refined, and inspired by new materials and technology. 'We must invent and rebuild our futurist city like an immense and tumultuous shipyard, active, mobile, and everywhere dynamic, and the futurist house like a gigantic machine.' The movement attracted poets, musicians, artists and architects, until several were killed after enlisting in the First World War. Although few futurist buildings were constructed, the ideas behind them were genuinely ahead of their time.



Plans by Sant'Elia, 1914